

Person: Ryan Abbott

Topic: Strengths

What are my strengths? I would say automation and reliability. I naturally look to simplify processes with automation whenever possible, which improves team efficiency and allows engineers to refocus their time on more important matters. I've taken processes that took 30 minutes of manual engineer work and consolidated them into a single button push that takes 5 minutes. I also implement testing infrastructure that allows for this automation without sacrificing reliability and uptime in the process. My test suites ensured critical APIs needed at all hours of the day remained operational, meaning equipment operators working across the world always had access, even at 2am, or that government agencies could trust mission-critical data delivered from my data pipelines.

As for soft skills, my versatility and adaptability. I've worked with a myriad of different business problems, in multiple industries, and delivered solutions that align with business objectives and fulfill promises. I've shipped both internal and customer-facing applications that align precisely with stakeholders' expectations. I've worked for teams that develop fully in the cloud, and with teams that operate entirely on-premises. I've built and tested ML models, then deployed and managed them. I've owned systems end-to-end, from design to deployment, and am comfortable adapting to wherever I am needed.

At my last company, I was initially tasked with designing ML workflows, but took ownership of DevOps as the project grew. As the scope and scale of the project evolved, our ML was effective, but how we served the ML was poor; response time was too slow, error communication to users and logging for developers was severely lacking, and the Databricks job we used to serve it broke 50% of the time. I took the initiative to re-design our deployment entirely. I moved the deployment to AWS, which cut our execution time down from a minute to 5 seconds; I established a test suite that always caught PRs that broke our code; finally, I constructed a CI/CD pipeline that handled the containerization, building, and deployment of new API releases.

I'm confident I can deliver in whatever environment, industry, or stack the role requires.